

The revision gap

What version 1.1 changed, what has retired since, and how to answer when the exam and reality disagree.

The exam guide is **one date**. AWS is a moving target. Answer from the guide.

What version 1.1 added

NEW SKILL	WHERE IT IS COVERED
1.2.10 Integrating LLMs for data processing	Module 5
2.1.7 Open table formats, Apache Iceberg	Module 9
2.1.8 Vector index types, HNSW and IVF	Module 11
2.2.6 Business catalogs, SageMaker Catalog	Module 12
2.4.6 Vectorisation concepts, Bedrock knowledge bases	Module 11
4.1.7 SageMaker Unified Studio, domains and projects	Modules 12 and 20
4.5.6 Data access through SageMaker Catalog projects	Module 20
4.5.7 Governance frameworks	Module 20

ON THE EXAM

Eight new skills. No question bank written before December 2025 covers any of them.

Why AWS added what it added

- ◆ Three of the eight skills are about **generative AI** or the vectors underneath it.
- ◆ Three are about the **SageMaker governance layer**, across two domains.
- ◆ One is **open table formats**, which is Iceberg.
- ◆ The pattern is a **job role catching up** with what data engineers now do.
- ◆ None of them replaced an existing skill. The guide grew rather than shifted.

ON THE EXAM

The revision reflects what changed in the job, not a change of opinion about what a data engineer should know.

Services added to scope

SERVICE	WHY IT MATTERS
Amazon Aurora	Zero-ETL to Redshift, and pgvector for embeddings
Amazon Bedrock	Unstructured input becomes structured data
Amazon Q	Authoring assistance, not a pipeline component
Amazon Kendra	Enterprise search over documents
AWS Data Exchange	Publishing datasets to external subscribers
Amazon S3 Tables	Managed Iceberg tables with automatic maintenance

ON THE EXAM

Six services newly in scope. Aurora and S3 Tables carry the most weight of these in practice.

Services removed from scope

- ◆ **AWS Cloud9**, the browser-based development environment.
- ◆ **AWS CodeCommit**, the Git hosting service.
- ◆ **AWS Schema Conversion Tool**, the standalone SCT application.
- ◆ **CodePipeline, CodeBuild and CodeDeploy remain**, working with any Git provider.
- ◆ **Skill 2.4.3 still names SCT** as an example, which contradicts the removal.

ON THE EXAM

The exam guide contradicts itself on SCT. Learn schema conversion as a concept, and expect either name.

Eleven services or features in this course
have **retired, closed or been renamed.**

Retired and closed, part one

SERVICE	STATUS AND SUCCESSOR
Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL	Applications deleted 27 Jan 2026. Use Managed Service for Apache Flink
AWS Snowmobile	Retired March 2024
AWS Snowcone	Discontinued Nov 2024, support ended Nov 2025. Use DataSync
AWS Snowball Edge	Closed to new customers 7 Nov 2025
AWS Snowball, all devices	Support ends in commercial Regions 31 Dec 2026
AWS Glue for Ray	Closed to new customers 30 Apr 2026. Use Ray on Amazon EKS

ON THE EXAM

The Snow Family is the biggest single change. Older material treats Snowball as the answer for large offline transfers.

Retired and closed, part two

FEATURE	STATUS AND SUCCESSOR
Amazon S3 Select	Closed to new customers 25 Jul 2024. Use Athena
S3 Glacier Select	Closed at the same time
S3 Object Lambda	Existing customers and select partners only, from 7 Nov 2025
Lake Formation Governed Tables	End of support 31 Dec 2024. Use Iceberg, Hudi or Delta
Redshift Python UDFs	End of support 30 Jun 2026. Use SQL or Lambda UDFs
AWS DMS Fleet Advisor	End of support 20 May 2026

ON THE EXAM

S3 Select appeared five times in the bank analysed for this course, and S3 Object Lambda four times.

Renamed, not retired

OLD NAME	CURRENT NAME
Kinesis Data Firehose	Amazon Data Firehose, since February 2024
Kinesis Data Analytics for Apache Flink	Managed Service for Apache Flink, since August 2023
Amazon QuickSight	Amazon Quick Suite in Oct 2025, then Amazon Quick
Aurora Serverless v2	Aurora serverless, since April 2026
Amazon DataZone	Also appears as Amazon SageMaker Catalog

ON THE EXAM

None of these changed what the service does. Treat old and new names as the same answer.

Newer than the exam guide

CHANGE	DATE
Redshift RG instances, removing Spectrum's per-TB charge	12 May 2026
Amazon MWAA Serverless	17 Nov 2025
AWS European Sovereign Cloud, generally available	15 Jan 2026
Athena capacity reservations from 4 DPUs, per minute	10 Feb 2026
CloudWatch Logs Infrequent Access gains SQL and PPL	27 Mar 2026
Lake Formation cross-account version 5	February 2026

ON THE EXAM

These postdate version 1.1. Know them so reality makes sense, and answer exam questions from the guide.

The three states a service can be in

STATE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR AN ANSWER
Retired or deleted	Gone. The exam may still name it; reality does not have it
Closed to new customers	Existing users continue. You could not adopt it today
End of support announced	Still working, with a date after which it is not
Renamed	Nothing changed except the name. Both names are the same answer
Superseded	Still present, and something better now exists

ON THE EXAM

Only the last two leave you free to pick the option on its merits. The first three are exam-catalogue answers.

Two changes that alter a classic answer

- ◆ **Spectrum's per-terabyte charge.** On RG instances it no longer exists.
- ◆ Several classic answers assume it does. Answer as though it does.
- ◆ **Paying for an idle MWAA environment.** Not true since MWAA Serverless.
- ◆ That argument decided many Step Functions against MWAA questions.
- ◆ Both changes postdate the exam guide, so both are context rather than content.

ON THE EXAM

These two matter more than the other post-guide changes, because each removes an argument the exam still relies on.

How to answer when the exam is stale

- ◆ **Answer from the exam's catalogue**, not from current best practice.
- ◆ **If a retired service is the only option that fits**, it is the intended answer.
- ◆ **If both an old and a new name appear**, they are the same answer. Pick either.
- ◆ **Do not reject an option** because you know the service has since closed.
- ◆ **Know both versions**, because one passes the exam and the other does the job.

ON THE EXAM

This is the only place in the course where the right exam answer and the right engineering answer can differ.

Where the December revision changed an answer

- ◆ **Unstructured input** now has a managed answer in Bedrock, not a custom pipeline.
- ◆ **Row-level deletion in a lake** is now Iceberg, not rewriting files.
- ◆ **Vector storage** is now a named skill with named index types.
- ◆ **Business catalogs** are now distinct from the technical catalog.
- ◆ **Governance** is now examinable as a framework, not only as permissions.

ON THE EXAM

Each of these is a question shape that did not exist before. They are where the newest questions will be.

Where older material is now actively wrong

- ◆ "Use a small DC2 cluster for development." DC2 was deprecated in April 2025.
- ◆ "MWAA means paying for an idle environment." Not since MWAA Serverless.
- ◆ "Use CodeCommit for pipeline source control." Removed from scope.
- ◆ "Redshift Python UDFs for custom logic." End of support June 2026.
- ◆ "Governed Tables for ACID in the lake." Superseded by open table formats.

ON THE EXAM

These are not subtle. Each was standard advice, and each is now incorrect as guidance.

Judging a source's currency

- ◆ Does it mention **Amazon Data Firehose**, or only Kinesis Data Firehose?
- ◆ Does it cover **Iceberg** as a table format, or only as a file format alongside Parquet?
- ◆ Does it mention **S3 Tables**, **Aurora** or **Bedrock** as in-scope services?
- ◆ Does it recommend **CodeCommit** or **DC2**? Then it predates 2025.
- ◆ **Three quick checks** tell you roughly when a source was written.

ON THE EXAM

Iceberg is the sharpest test. Treated as a file format, the source predates the December 2025 revision.

What has not changed

- ◆ **The four domains and their weightings.** Still 34, 26, 22 and 18 percent.
- ◆ **The exam format.** Sixty five questions, fifty scored, a hundred and thirty minutes.
- ◆ **The core services.** Glue, S3, Redshift, Athena, Kinesis, Lambda.
- ◆ **The qualifier vocabulary.** Least operational overhead still decides most questions.
- ◆ **The reasoning.** Access pattern, frequency, existing technology, overhead.

ON THE EXAM

The revision added at the edges. The centre of this exam is the same as it was, and it is where most marks are.

The whole gap, in one table

CATEGORY	COUNT
New skills in version 1.1	8
Services added to scope	6
Services removed from scope	3
Retired, deleted or closed to new customers	10
Renamed but unchanged	5
Significant changes after the guide was published	6

ON THE EXAM

Thirty eight items. Every one was verified against AWS documentation during the making of this course.

What this course did about the gap

- ◆ Every fact was web-checked at the time its module was written.
- ◆ Dates were recorded, so any claim here can be verified independently.
- ◆ Availability warnings got their own slides in the modules where they arose.
- ◆ The bank was used as a topic map only, never as a source of answers.
- ◆ Where AWS and the exam guide disagree, both positions were stated.

ON THE EXAM

The last point is the method. Nothing in this course hides a divergence to keep an explanation tidy.

How to use this module

- ◆ **Read it once now**, to know what is here.
- ◆ **Reread the three warning tables the night before.** They are pure recognition.
- ◆ **If you revise from an older bank**, check its answers against these tables.
- ◆ **Do not try to learn the dates.** No question will ask for one.
- ◆ **Learn the status and the successor**, which is what changes an answer.

ON THE EXAM

Next: three practice exams of twenty questions each, with the reasoning worked through for every option.